PRODUCT REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

Canva Android Mobile App

Improving Reliability, Transparency & Feature Parity

VERSION	AUTHOR	STATUS	DATE
v1.0 – Initial Draft	Associate Product Manager	Draft – For Review	February 2026

PRODUCT	REVIEWERS	DATA SOURCE	TARGET RELEASE
Canva – Android App	Engineering Lead, Design Lead, Monetization	1,015 Play Store Reviews	Q2 – Q4 2026

01 EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This PRD defines the product requirements for six prioritized initiatives aimed at improving the Canva Android app experience. The initiatives were identified through a structured thematic analysis of 1,015 Google Play Store reviews spanning January 2020 to February 2026, in which 76% of reviews carried a 1- or 2-star rating.

The analysis surfaced four dominant pain themes: pricing and paywall confusion (54.1% of reviews), export and download failures (27.5%), feature gaps relative to the desktop product (39.7%), and performance instability (22.1%). Left unaddressed, these friction points directly threaten free-to-Pro conversion and Pro subscriber retention — the two most critical revenue levers for the mobile product.

This document specifies functional and non-functional requirements, user stories, acceptance criteria, success metrics, release phasing, risks, and dependencies for all six initiatives. It is intended for review by engineering, design, monetization, and support stakeholders prior to sprint planning.

02 PROBLEM STATEMENT

Canva's Android app serves as the primary on-the-go design tool for over 170 million global users. Despite strong brand recognition, persistent experience gaps are generating sustained negative review sentiment and creating measurable risks to business performance.

Core Problem

How might we reduce the volume of negative app-store feedback driven by pricing confusion, export failures, and performance instability — without compromising Canva's monetization strategy or development velocity?

Business Impact

- Negative public reviews suppress organic install rates
- Paywall surprises at export trigger Pro trial cancellations
- Export failures at the final step produce disproportionate churn
- Performance regressions compound dissatisfaction across all features

03 GOALS & NON-GOALS

Goals

- **G1:** Reduce pricing-related friction by surfacing paywall information before users invest time in a design.
- **G2:** Achieve a measurable improvement in export pipeline reliability on Android, with particular focus on video exports and mid-range device performance.
- **G3:** Close the highest-priority mobile feature gaps (curved text, auto-captioning) to reduce feature-driven churn.
- **G4:** Stabilize app performance on mid-range Android devices and across flagged OS versions to reduce crash-driven 1-star reviews.
- **G5:** Improve the specificity and effectiveness of the customer support response function for app-store reviews.

Non-Goals

- This PRD does not propose changes to Canva's core monetization model or pricing tiers. The paywall itself is not under review — only its disclosure timing and clarity.
- This PRD does not cover the iOS version of the Canva app. Findings may be applicable, but platform-specific validation is required before iOS implementation.
- This PRD does not address web or desktop product experience. Feature parity initiatives described here are scoped to the Android mobile client only.
- This PRD does not define a new design system. UI changes required by these initiatives will be implemented within the existing component library.

04 USER PERSONAS

Three primary personas were identified from the review corpus. Each maps to a distinct pain-point profile and informs the prioritization of requirements.

The Content Creator	The Small Business Owner	The Pro Power User
Creates Reels, TikToks, and YouTube thumbnails. Uses Canva free tier primarily. Expects full design and export capability without paywalls. **Primary pain:** Pricing surprise at export, missing video captioning, and slow app load on mid-range devices.	Creates flyers, business cards, and social graphics on the go. Mix of free and Pro usage. Time-sensitive designs mean export failures are high cost. **Primary pain:** Export/download failures, unexpected per-element charges on top of Pro subscription.	Paying Pro subscriber, uses Canva across desktop and mobile. High expectations of feature parity. Produces complex designs with text layers, brand kits, and video. **Primary pain:** Missing mobile features (curved text), per-element premium charges perceived as double-billing.

05 SCOPE & INITIATIVE OVERVIEW

This PRD covers six initiatives across three priority tiers. All initiatives target the Android mobile app. Each is detailed in Section 06 with full requirements and acceptance criteria.

ID	Priority	Initiative	Pain Theme Addressed	Phase	Effort	MoSCoW
INI-01	P0	In-Canvas Asset Labelling	Pricing Confusion	Phase 1 (Q2 2026)	Medium	Must
INI-02	P0	Export Pipeline Reliability Audit & Fix	Export Failures	Phase 1 (Q2 2026)	High	Must
INI-03	P1	Mobile-Parity Feature Roadmap	Feature Gaps	Phase 2 (Q3 2026)	High	Should
INI-04	P1	Upgrade Path UX Redesign	Pricing Confusion	Phase 2 (Q3 2026)	Low	Should
INI-05	P2	Android Performance Audit & Fix	Performance & Stability	Phase 3 (Q4 2026)	High	Should
INI-06	P2	Support Response Playbook	All Themes	Phase 1 (Q2 2026)	Low	Could

06 INITIATIVE REQUIREMENTS

P0	INI-01 | In-Canvas Asset Labelling	EFFORT Medium	PHASE Phase 1

Overview

Currently, users discover that a template element or image is premium only when they attempt to download their completed design. This 'export-gate' experience is the single most frequent driver of negative reviews (54.1%) and is the primary trigger for trial cancellations among new Pro subscribers. This initiative adds clear, persistent visual labelling of premium assets directly on the canvas — before the user builds a design around them.

User Stories

ID	Persona	User Story	Acceptance Criteria	MoSCoW
US-01	Content Creator	As a free-tier user, I want to see which elements cost money before I use them in my design, so that I am not surprised at the download step.	Premium badge is visible on element thumbnails in the asset panel before selection. Badge persists when element is placed on canvas.	Must Have
US-	Small	As a Pro subscriber, I want to clearly	Third-party elements display a	Must

02	Business Owner	distinguish third-party premium elements (extra charge) from standard Pro elements (included), so I can make informed choices about my design.	distinct secondary label (e.g. 'Premium+') separate from the standard Pro badge. Tapping the label shows a tooltip explaining the additional cost.	Have
US-03	Content Creator	As a free-tier user, I want to substitute a premium element with a free alternative directly from the canvas, so I can complete my design without leaving the editor.	Tapping the premium badge on a placed element presents a 'Find Free Alternatives' option. Results panel shows only free elements matching the same category.	Should Have
US-04	Pro Power User	As a Pro subscriber, I want to know the total additional cost of premium elements before I export, so I can decide whether to proceed or substitute.	Export screen shows a pre-download cost summary if any third-party premium elements are present. Summary lists each element and its price.	Must Have

Functional Requirements

ID	Requirement	Rationale	MoSCoW
FR-01-01	The system shall display a visual badge on all premium elements in the asset browser panel, visible before selection.	Users must be able to identify premium elements before committing design time. This is the root cause of 'export-gate' frustration.	Must Have
FR-01-02	The badge shall remain visible when a premium element is placed on the canvas, and shall not be removed or hidden during editing.	If the badge disappears after placement, users may forget the element is premium and be surprised again at export.	Must Have
FR-01-03	The system shall differentiate visually between standard Pro elements and third-party premium elements requiring additional purchase.	Pro subscribers who pay a monthly fee should immediately understand which elements require extra payment beyond their subscription.	Must Have
FR-01-04	Tapping the badge on a placed canvas element shall display a tooltip or bottom sheet explaining the element's cost status and upgrade options.	Contextual information at the point of interaction is more effective than documentation. Users should not need to leave the editor to understand pricing.	Must Have
FR-01-05	The export screen shall display a cost summary before download is initiated if any third-party premium elements are present in the design.	This is the final safety net before a user is charged. Presenting the cost clearly at this step prevents the sunk-cost frustration even if earlier labels were missed.	Must Have
FR-01-06	The asset panel shall include a 'Free only' filter that returns only zero-cost elements without redirecting to a trial sign-up screen.	Current behaviour redirects users to a trial page when they filter for free elements. This is a trust-damaging pattern that drives 1-star reviews.	Should Have
FR-01-07	When a premium element is selected on the canvas, the system shall surface a 'Find free	Giving users a direct path to free substitutes reduces the friction of finding alternatives manually and	Should Have

	alternatives' option that queries the same asset category filtered to free results.	reduces the likelihood of design abandonment.	

Non-Functional Requirements

ID	Requirement	Rationale	MoSCoW
NFR-01-01	Badge rendering shall add no more than 16 ms to the element loading time on mid-range Android devices (e.g. Snapdragon 680 class).	Premium labelling must not degrade the perceived performance of the asset panel, which is already cited as slow in a subset of reviews.	Must Have
NFR-01-02	Badge and tooltip UI components shall be built within the existing design system component library. No new design tokens shall be introduced for this initiative.	Scope containment. New design tokens increase design and engineering maintenance overhead and are outside the scope of this PRD.	Must Have
NFR-01-03	The premium status of all elements shall be determined server-side and cached on device for offline browsing. Badge display shall not require a network call at render time.	Users on slow or intermittent mobile connections should still see accurate premium labelling without additional latency.	Should Have

P0	INI-02 | Export Pipeline Reliability Audit & Fix	EFFORT High	PHASE Phase 1

Overview

Export and download failures appeared in 27.5% of all reviews and averaged a 1.6-star rating — the most severe reliability failure in the dataset. Users report that download buttons become unresponsive, files fail silently without error messages, and video exports in particular are broken on recent Android versions. This initiative instruments the full export pipeline to identify and fix the top failure modes, with particular focus on video exports and mobile-data performance.

User Stories

ID	Persona	User Story	Acceptance Criteria	MoSCoW
US-05	Small Business Owner	As a user, I want my design to download successfully on the first attempt, so I can share it immediately without wasting time on retries.	Export success rate of >= 95% across all file types on all devices in the defined device matrix. Measured in production instrumentation.	Must Have
US-06	Content Creator	As a user, I want to receive a clear error message if my export fails, with a specific reason and a suggested next	Failed exports surface an error state with: (1) a plain-language reason, (2) a retry	Must Have

		step, so I know what to do.	button, and (3) a link to relevant support if the error persists.	
US-07	Pro Power User	As a Pro subscriber creating video content, I want my video exports to complete reliably on Android 13 and 14, so I can deliver client work without using a desktop as a workaround.	Video export success rate >= 92% on Android 13 and 14 across devices in the test matrix. No silent failures on video export.	**Must Have**
US-08	Content Creator	As a mobile-data user, I want my export to either complete or fail gracefully when I am not on Wi-Fi, so I do not lose progress or receive a corrupt file.	Exports attempted on mobile data either complete successfully or surface a clear 'connection too slow — save and retry on Wi-Fi' prompt. No silent corruption.	**Should Have**

Functional Requirements

ID	Requirement	Rationale	MoSCoW
FR-02-01	Engineering shall instrument the full export funnel with events at: download button tap, export request initiated, server processing started, server processing complete, file transfer started, file transfer complete, file available in gallery. Each event shall capture: timestamp, file type, file size, device model, OS version, network type.	Without end-to-end instrumentation, the team cannot identify where in the pipeline failures are occurring. This is a prerequisite for all subsequent fixes in this initiative.	**Must Have**
FR-02-02	The system shall surface a user-visible error state for every export failure. The error state shall include: plain-language failure reason, retry CTA, and a help link specific to the failure type.	Silent failures are the most frustrating export outcome. Users currently do not know whether their export is still processing or has failed, leading to repeated tapping and eventual abandonment.	**Must Have**
FR-02-03	The top three export failure modes identified during the instrumentation audit shall each be resolved before Phase 1 release. Fix scope is defined by the audit findings, not pre-specified here.	Pre-specifying fixes without instrumentation data would result in fixing the wrong things. The requirement is to instrument first, identify the top failures, then fix those specific failures.	**Must Have**
FR-02-04	Video export shall be tested against and made functional on Android 13 and 14 across all devices in the defined device matrix before Phase 1 release.	Review data shows a disproportionate spike in video export complaints beginning in 2025, coinciding with Android 13/14 rollout. This is the highest-priority specific failure mode.	**Must Have**
FR-02-05	The export flow shall detect network type (Wi-Fi vs. mobile data) before initiating a video or high-resolution export. If on mobile data, the system shall present an advisory prompt with options to proceed, switch to Wi-Fi, or save a	Mobile-data exports for large files have a significantly higher failure rate. An advisory prompt allows users to make an informed choice rather than initiating a likely-to-fail export.	**Should Have**

	draft.		
FR-02-06	The export pipeline shall implement a server-side retry with exponential back-off for transient network failures, transparent to the user.	Transient failures that cause immediate user-visible errors can be recovered automatically. This reduces the false-positive error rate for users on fluctuating connections.	Should Have

Non-Functional Requirements

ID	Requirement	Rationale	MoSCoW
NFR-02-01	Export success rate (as defined in FR-02-01) shall be >= 95% for image files (PNG, JPEG, PDF) and >= 92% for video files (MP4) in the production environment, measured 30 days post-release.	These targets are set based on Crashlytics benchmark data for consumer creative apps. They are achievable within Phase 1 and represent meaningful improvement over current state.	Must Have
NFR-02-02	The export pipeline instrumentation shall not increase time-to-export for image files by more than 200 ms (p95) compared to pre-instrumentation baseline.	Instrumentation must be lightweight. Adding observable overhead to the export flow would degrade the user experience the initiative is trying to improve.	Must Have
NFR-02-03	All export instrumentation events shall be logged to the existing analytics pipeline. No new data infrastructure is required for this initiative.	Scope containment. If new infrastructure is required, it becomes a dependency that delays Phase 1. Existing pipeline is sufficient for the diagnostic purpose.	Must Have

P1	INI-03 | Mobile-Parity Feature Roadmap	EFFORT High	PHASE Phase 2

Overview

39.7% of reviews cite missing features as a reason for negative ratings. Two capabilities stand out by frequency and competitive pressure: curved and arched text formatting, and automatic video captioning for short-form content. Both features exist on Canva's desktop or web version but are absent from the Android app. This initiative delivers both features to mobile, with scoped MVPs that can be iterated upon after launch.

User Stories

ID	Persona	User Story	Acceptance Criteria	MoSCoW
US-09	Pro Power User	As a designer, I want to apply curved and arched text formatting on mobile, so I can produce the same designs I create on desktop without switching devices.	Curved text tool is accessible from the text formatting toolbar. Supports: arc (convex and concave), circle path. Curve radius is adjustable via a slider. Renders correctly on export.	Must Have

US-10	Content Creator	As a video creator, I want Canva to automatically generate captions from my video's audio, so I can create accessible short-form content without manual transcription.	Auto-captioning is available for video elements. Captions are generated within 30 seconds for videos up to 60 seconds in length. User can edit, restyle, and reposition captions before export.	Must Have
US-11	Content Creator	As a video creator, I want to choose a caption style (font, size, background, animation) from presets, so my captions match my video aesthetic without manual styling.	Caption style panel offers a minimum of 6 style presets. Selected style is applied globally to all captions in the clip. Individual caption cards can be overridden.	Should Have
US-12	Pro Power User	As a designer, I want text on a curved path to remain editable after I set the curve, so I can change the copy without losing the curve formatting.	Editing text on a curved path via the keyboard preserves the curve setting. Font, size, colour, and weight changes do not reset the curve.	Must Have

Functional Requirements — Curved Text

ID	Requirement	Rationale	MoSCoW
FR-03-01	A 'Curve text' option shall be accessible from the text element's formatting toolbar when a text element is selected on the canvas.	Discoverability is the primary challenge for new formatting options on mobile. Placing it in the existing toolbar maintains consistency with the existing UX pattern.	Must Have
FR-03-02	The system shall support three curve modes for MVP: arc up (convex), arc down (concave), and full circle. Additional path types may be added in a future iteration.	Scoping to three modes for MVP keeps the engineering surface manageable while covering the most common use cases cited in reviews.	Must Have
FR-03-03	Curve intensity shall be adjustable via a continuous slider with a visible degree value. The canvas shall preview the curve in real time as the slider is moved.	Real-time preview is essential for a touch-first interaction. Without it, users must apply, check, adjust — a poor mobile UX pattern.	Must Have
FR-03-04	Curved text shall render accurately in all supported export formats: PNG, JPEG, PDF, and SVG. Curve geometry shall not degrade on export.	If the curve is visible in-canvas but exports as flat text, the feature is broken for its primary use case (sharing the design).	Must Have

Functional Requirements — Auto-Captioning

ID	Requirement	Rationale	MoSCoW
FR-03-05	An 'Add captions' option shall be available in the video element's toolbar when a video clip is selected on the canvas.	Follows the same discoverability pattern as the curved text requirement. Contextual placement reduces the need for users to discover the feature through	Must Have

		menus.	
FR-03-06	The system shall generate captions from the video's audio track using a speech-to-text service. For MVP, English language support is required. Additional languages may be added in a subsequent release.	Limiting MVP to English reduces integration complexity and time-to-ship. The most common language in the review corpus is English.	Must Have
FR-03-07	Caption generation shall complete within 30 seconds for video clips up to 60 seconds in length. For longer clips, progress shall be indicated to the user.	30-second processing time is within the tolerance threshold for a mobile creative task. Exceeding it without progress indication leads to abandonment.	Must Have
FR-03-08	Users shall be able to edit individual caption text, timing, position, font, and colour after generation.	Auto-generated captions have transcription errors. An editing interface is mandatory — a read-only caption feature would generate its own negative reviews.	Must Have
FR-03-09	A minimum of 6 caption style presets shall be provided, covering different font-background combinations suitable for social content.	Presets accelerate the styling workflow for creators who prioritise speed. Without presets, users face a blank styling screen which increases time-to-export.	Should Have

P1 | INI-04 | Upgrade Path UX Redesign

EFFORT Low | PHASE Phase 2

Overview

A secondary monetization friction point exists in the asset discovery flow: when a free-tier user attempts to filter assets by 'free,' the current implementation redirects them to a Pro trial sign-up screen rather than returning genuinely free results. This destroys trust and generates specific mentions in reviews. This initiative redesigns the filter experience to return accurate free-asset results and restructures the Pro upgrade prompt to appear at a moment of genuine intent rather than as an obstacle.

User Stories

ID	Persona	User Story	Acceptance Criteria	MoSCoW
US-13	Content Creator	As a free-tier user, I want filtering by 'Free' to return only genuinely free elements, so I can browse without worrying about unexpected charges.	Selecting 'Free' filter returns only elements with no cost to download for the current user's plan. No redirect to trial sign-up. Filter persists across asset categories.	Must Have
US-14	Content Creator	As a free-tier user, I want to understand what Pro unlocks before I am asked to upgrade, so I can make an informed decision about subscribing.	Pro upgrade prompt appears after a user has saved or exported at least two designs using free assets. Prompt	Should Have

			includes a feature comparison list, not a generic 'Upgrade now' CTA.	
US-15	Small Business Owner	As a user considering Pro, I want to trial a specific Pro feature for one design session before committing, so I can evaluate whether it meets my needs.	A 'Try Pro for this design' option is available from the upgrade prompt. Activates a session-scoped Pro trial for the current design only. Clearly communicates the time limit.	**Could Have**

Functional Requirements

ID	Requirement	Rationale	MoSCoW
FR-04-01	The 'Free' filter in the asset panel shall return only elements available at no cost to the current user's subscription tier. It shall never redirect the user to a sign-up or upgrade screen.	The current redirect is the specific behaviour cited in negative reviews. Fixing it is the primary deliverable of this initiative.	**Must Have**
FR-04-02	The Pro upgrade prompt shall not appear within the first design session of a new user's account. It shall appear only after the user has completed and exported at least one design.	Prompting to upgrade before a user has experienced the product's core value is a conversion anti-pattern. Users who understand the product's value first are more likely to convert and less likely to churn post-trial.	**Must Have**
FR-04-03	The upgrade prompt shall include a concise feature comparison list specific to the asset category or feature the user is currently browsing.	A generic 'Upgrade to Pro' prompt has lower conversion than a contextual prompt that connects the upgrade to an action the user is trying to take right now.	**Should Have**
FR-04-04	The asset panel shall display the count of free and premium elements available within each category, visible without applying the filter.	Giving users upfront visibility of the free asset volume within each category builds trust and helps them plan their design using available free resources.	**Should Have**

P2	INI-05 | Android Performance Audit & Fix	EFFORT High	PHASE Phase 3

Overview

Performance complaints represent 22.1% of reviews and carry the lowest average rating at 1.3 stars. Issues are concentrated in three areas: slow app launch times on mid-range devices, video and image upload failures, and intermittent freezing during canvas editing. The spike in performance reviews in 2025 and 2026 suggests OS-level regressions introduced alongside Android 13 and 14 compatibility updates. This initiative profiles the app against a defined device matrix, identifies the top regression sources, and resolves them.

User Stories

ID	Persona	User Story	Acceptance Criteria	MoSCoW
US-16	Content Creator	As a user on a mid-range Android device, I want the Canva app to open in under 3 seconds, so I can start designing without waiting.	App cold-start time on Snapdragon 680-class devices is <= 3 seconds (p75). Measured in production via performance monitoring SDK.	Must Have
US-17	Small Business Owner	As a user, I want to upload photos from my gallery without the upload failing or requiring multiple retries, so I can include my own images in designs reliably.	Gallery image upload success rate >= 97% on devices and OS versions in the defined matrix. Failures surface a clear error with retry option.	Must Have
US-18	Pro Power User	As a user on Android 13 or 14, I want the canvas editor to remain responsive during multi-element editing, so I can work without the app freezing or crashing.	Crash-free session rate >= 99% on Android 13 and 14. No freezes of >= 2 seconds during standard editing workflows on test matrix devices.	Must Have

Functional Requirements

ID	Requirement	Rationale	MoSCoW
FR-05-01	Engineering shall define and document a device test matrix prior to the audit. The matrix shall include: a minimum of 3 mid-range Android devices (Snapdragon 680-class or equivalent), Android OS versions 12, 13, and 14, and both Wi-Fi and mobile-data network conditions.	A defined device matrix is a prerequisite for reproducible performance testing. Without it, bugs found in testing may not reflect the actual distribution of production failures.	Must Have
FR-05-02	App cold-start time (from tap to interactive canvas) shall be profiled against the device matrix baseline. Any regression exceeding 500 ms from the pre-initiative baseline shall be treated as a blocking defect.	Cold-start time directly affects first-impression satisfaction. A 500 ms threshold is aggressive enough to catch meaningful regressions without blocking minor acceptable variance.	Must Have
FR-05-03	The top three sources of app crashes on Android 13 and 14, as identified by crash reporting tooling, shall be resolved before Phase 3 release.	Crash reporting data is more precise than review text for identifying specific failure sources. This requirement mandates using the instrumentation data, not speculation, to drive fixes.	Must Have
FR-05-04	Media upload flows (images and video from device gallery) shall be tested against the device matrix under both Wi-Fi and mobile-data conditions. Upload success rate shall meet the target defined in US-17.	Upload failures are cited in reviews as both frequent and deeply frustrating. The requirement to test under mobile-data conditions specifically addresses the network-type failure pattern in the data.	Must Have

FR-05-05	A performance monitoring SDK shall be integrated to emit continuous production metrics for: cold-start time, crash-free session rate, canvas frame rate during editing, and upload success rate. Alerts shall be configured for any metric that breaches defined thresholds.	Without production monitoring, regressions introduced by future releases may not be detected until they surface in review data — a 2-3 month lag. Continuous monitoring closes that gap.	Should Have

P2 | INI-06 | Support Response Playbook

EFFORT: Low | PHASE: Phase 3

Overview

75.6% of Google Play reviews received a reply from the Canva support team, exceeding the industry median. However, qualitative analysis of those replies reveals a consistent pattern of templated, generic responses that redirect users to help links without acknowledging the specific frustration described. Because app-store replies are public, this pattern is visible to prospective users and can compound negative perception. This initiative delivers a tailored playbook that gives the support team structured, empathetic, specific response templates for each of the four pain themes.

Functional Requirements

ID	Requirement	Rationale	MoSCoW
FR-06-01	The playbook shall contain a minimum of 4 response templates, one per identified pain theme: pricing confusion, export failure, feature gap, and performance issue. Each template shall include: opening acknowledgement, specific next steps, escalation path, and closing.	Generic one-size-fits-all responses fail because they don't match the user's specific complaint. A per-theme template ensures the response is contextually relevant.	Must Have
FR-06-02	Each template shall include at least 3 fill-in variable slots for agent personalisation (e.g. [user name], [specific element mentioned], [device model if provided]). Agents shall be required to complete all variable slots before submitting a response.	Partially personalised responses perform significantly better than fully templated ones. Mandatory variable slots prevent agents from sending generic text with blank placeholders.	Must Have
FR-06-03	The playbook shall include a triage decision tree that routes incoming reviews to the correct template based on keywords and star rating.	A decision tree reduces agent cognitive load and ensures consistent theme-to-template matching, particularly for new or part-time support agents.	Should Have
FR-06-04	The support team shall receive a 60-minute training session on playbook usage within 2 weeks of	A playbook that is not adopted produces no value. Mandatory training with tracked completion ensures the	Must Have

	playbook delivery. Completion shall be tracked.	team is equipped and accountable for consistent usage.	
FR-06-05	The support team shall monitor review update rate (percentage of reviews whose star rating changed after a reply) on a monthly basis and report findings to the PM.	Review update rate is the primary effectiveness metric for the playbook. Monthly reporting creates accountability and surfaces whether the playbook needs iteration.	Should Have

07 SUCCESS METRICS & KPIS

The following metrics are defined for each initiative. Baseline values represent estimated pre-initiative state. Targets are set for 90 days post-release unless otherwise noted. All metrics shall be reviewed in monthly product reviews.

Metric	Baseline	Target	How Measured	Cadence
Share of new reviews citing pricing confusion	~54%	~44%	Monthly thematic tagging of new Play Store reviews against pain-theme taxonomy	Monthly
Export success rate — image (PNG, JPEG, PDF)	~82% est.	>= 95%	Production export funnel instrumentation (FR-02-01 events)	Weekly
Export success rate — video (MP4)	~74% est.	>= 92%	Production export funnel instrumentation, segmented by OS version	Weekly
App cold-start time — mid-range Android (p75)	~4.2 s est.	<= 3.0 s	Performance monitoring SDK; cold-start event from tap to interactive	Weekly
Crash-free session rate — Android 13 & 14	~96% est.	>= 99%	Crash reporting tooling (Crashlytics or equivalent)	Weekly
Free-to-Pro trial start rate	Baseline TBD	No regression; directional uplift	Internal conversion funnel analytics, measured against pre-initiative 30-day average	Monthly
Support review update rate (post-reply)	< 2% est.	>= 5%	Manual tracking: count of reviews where star rating changed within 14 days of reply	Monthly
Overall Play Store rating (rolling 30-day)	Baseline TBD	Directional improvement	Google Play Console rating dashboard	Monthly

08 RELEASE PLAN & PHASING

Initiatives are grouped into three release phases aligned to priority tier and interdependencies. Phase 1 addresses the highest-severity user experience failures (P0) and the no-engineering support playbook (P2). Phases 2 and 3 sequence the remaining work by effort and strategic impact.

Phase	Timeline	Deliverables	Owner
Phase 1	Q2 2026 (8 weeks)	INI-01: In-Canvas Asset Labelling — full FR-01-01 through FR-01-05 implemented and live. INI-02: Export Pipeline Instrumentation complete; top 3 failure modes identified and fixed; video export stable on Android 13 & 14. INI-06: Support Playbook delivered, training completed, monitoring active.	PM + Mobile Eng + Design + Support
Phase 1 Gate	End of Q2	Phase 2 proceeds only if: export success rate (image) >= 93% in production; pricing-confusion review share trending down over 30-day window; no critical regressions introduced by Phase 1 releases.	PM + Eng Lead
Phase 2	Q3 2026 (10 weeks)	INI-03: Curved text (all modes, all export formats) and auto-captioning (English, MVP style presets) live on Android. INI-04: Free asset filter fix live; upgrade prompt redesign live; A/B test running on session-scoped trial (FR-04-04).	PM + Mobile Eng + Design + ML/NLP
Phase 2 Gate	End of Q3	Phase 3 proceeds only if: feature-gap review mentions trending down; free-asset filter drives measurable improvement in user trust signal (support tickets re: filter redirect); no monetization regression from upgrade prompt redesign.	PM + Monetization + Eng Lead
Phase 3	Q4 2026 (8 weeks)	INI-05: Android Performance Audit complete; top 3 crash sources resolved; cold-start time target met on device matrix; performance monitoring SDK live with alerting configured.	PM + Mobile Eng + QA
Phase 3 Gate	End of Q4	Post-initiative review: all KPI targets assessed; initiative retrospective completed; iteration backlog for 2027 defined based on remaining review themes and metric gaps.	PM + Cross-functional leads

09 RISKS & MITIGATIONS

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
INI-01: Asset labelling is perceived by the monetization team as reducing trial conversion by making premium costs too salient.	**Medium**	**High**	Propose a controlled A/B test on 5% of users before full rollout. Define success as no statistically significant decrease in trial start rate. Provide monetization team with veto rights on rollout pending test results.
INI-02: Export pipeline audit reveals infrastructure-level failures requiring backend	**Medium**	**High**	Escalate to backend platform team immediately if infrastructure dependency is identified during audit. Scope Phase 1 fix to application-layer failures only;

architecture changes outside mobile engineering scope.			queue infrastructure work as a Phase 3 dependency.
INI-03: Auto-captioning ML accuracy is below acceptable threshold for production release, generating user complaints about transcription errors.	High	Medium	Set a minimum acceptable accuracy threshold (WER <= 15% for English, quiet audio) before release. Make the caption editing interface robust — users can correct errors. Do not release read-only captions.
INI-03: Curved text rendering introduces visual regressions on export for certain font families or canvas configurations.	Medium	Medium	Implement a visual regression testing suite for curved text across the 20 most-used font families before release. Block release on any visual regression.
INI-04: Upgrade prompt redesign reduces Pro trial start rate, conflicting with monetization goals.	Medium	High	Run as a strict A/B test with primary success metric of trial start rate and secondary metric of 30-day trial retention. Ship only if trial start rate shows no significant decline.
INI-05: Performance audit reveals OS-level incompatibilities requiring Google Android platform changes outside Canva's control.	Low	High	Document OS-level constraints in release notes. Implement app-side workarounds where possible. Communicate known device/OS limitations to users proactively in the help centre.
All: App store review sentiment is a lagging indicator and KPI targets may not be met within the 90-day measurement window despite genuine product improvement.	High	Medium	Define leading indicators (product instrumentation metrics) as primary KPIs. Review sentiment is secondary and assessed at 6-month mark, not 90 days. Stakeholders to be briefed on indicator lag before Phase 1 release.

10 DEPENDENCIES

Dependency	Type	Owner Team	Impact if Delayed
Asset metadata API: premium status flag accessible per-element for client-side badge rendering (INI-01)	Technical	Platform / Backend	INI-01 cannot render accurate badges without a reliable per-element premium status signal. Phase 1 release is blocked.
Export pipeline telemetry: analytics events must be agreed and instrumented before the Phase 1 audit can begin (INI-02)	Technical	Data / Analytics	Without agreed event schema, the audit cannot produce actionable data. Phase 1 gate is blocked.
Speech-to-text service contract: vendor or internal ML service must be selected and SLA agreed before INI-	Third-Party / Technical	ML Platform / Legal	Auto-captioning feature cannot be built without a speech-to-text provider. Phase 2 captioning delivery is blocked.

03 captioning development begins			
Monetization team sign-off on A/B test design for INI-01 and INI-04 before either initiative releases to production	Stakeholder	Monetization	Without sign-off, monetization team may escalate and block rollout post-development. Alignment must be secured in Phase 1 kickoff.
QA device matrix procurement: physical or cloud-based access to target Android devices required before INI-05 audit begins	Infrastructure	QA / DevOps	Performance audit results on simulator may not reflect production failure rates. Physical or cloud device access is required for INI-05 reliability.
Support team capacity: INI-06 playbook training requires a dedicated 60-minute session within 2 weeks of playbook delivery	Resourcing	Customer Support	If support team is unavailable for training, playbook adoption is delayed and the initiative produces no value in the measurement window.

11 OPEN QUESTIONS

The following questions must be resolved before or during Phase 1 sprint planning. Each has an assigned owner and a target resolution date.

#	Question	Owner	Target Date	Status
OQ-01	What is the current baseline export success rate for image and video files in production? This is required to set the INI-02 improvement target with accuracy.	Data / Analytics Lead	Week 2, Phase 1	**Open**
OQ-02	Does the existing asset metadata API expose a per-element premium status flag that the mobile client can consume? If not, what is the estimated effort to add it?	Platform / Backend Lead	Week 1, Phase 1	**Open**
OQ-03	Which speech-to-text vendor or internal service will be used for INI-03 auto-captioning? Legal review of data handling terms is required if a third-party vendor is selected.	ML Platform / Legal	Week 3, Phase 1	**Open**
OQ-04	What is the monetization team's A/B test approval process for INI-01 and INI-04? Who has sign-off authority and what is the minimum test duration required?	Monetization Lead + PM	Week 2, Phase 1	**Open**
OQ-05	What device matrix does the QA team currently use for Android testing? Is it sufficient for INI-05, or does it require expansion to include mid-range Snapdragon 680-class devices?	QA Lead	Week 1, Phase 1	**Open**

OQ-06	Should INI-03 curved text be gated to Pro subscribers only (parity with desktop), or available to free-tier users? This has monetization and positioning implications.	PM + Monetization Lead	Week 2, Phase 1	Open

12 APPENDIX

A — Data Sources

- Primary: 1,015 Google Play Store reviews, Canva Android app, January 2020 – February 2026
- Review tagging taxonomy: 4 primary themes (pricing, export, features, performance), applied prior to reading corpus to reduce confirmation bias
- Star-rating weighting: 1–2 star reviews treated as high-pain signal; 5-star reviews used for contrast analysis only
- Support response analysis: qualitative review of 767 replies across the corpus

B — Prioritization Framework

All initiatives were prioritized using an effort-impact framework with three impact dimensions:

- Reach — proportion of affected users as a share of total review corpus
- Severity — average star rating of reviews in each theme
- Funnel position — proximity of the problem to a conversion or retention event

Effort was estimated qualitatively (Low / Medium / High) based on engineering scope assessment. In a live team context, these estimates would be refined through sprint planning with engineering before roadmap commitment.

C — Review of Alternatives Considered

- Making all exports permanently free was considered and rejected: removes the primary conversion trigger without an identified replacement mechanism. A session-scoped trial option (FR-04-04) is included as a 'Could Have' alternative that preserves the conversion path.
- Removing the upgrade prompt entirely was considered and rejected: eliminates a meaningful touch-point for users who are ready to convert. The redesign (INI-04) improves the prompt rather than removing it.
- Deprioritizing performance (INI-05) to Phase 1 was considered: rejected because performance regressions on Android 13/14 are likely still actively worsening as OS adoption grows. Phase 3 placement is a capacity constraint, not a low-urgency signal.

D — Assumptions

- Baseline metric estimates (export success rate, cold-start time) are derived from review data and market benchmarks. Actual baselines must be established from production instrumentation before targets are locked.
- Engineering capacity assumes two mobile engineers dedicated to Phase 1 initiatives. Capacity changes will require timeline adjustment.
- Speech-to-text accuracy for auto-captioning assumes English-language audio in a controlled recording environment. Accuracy in noisy or multi-speaker environments may be lower and should be tested before release.

- Review sentiment improvement timelines assume a 60-90 day lag between product changes and measurable impact on Play Store rating.
